



(in the name of one George de Mestral) and was inspired by the way burrs (a prickly fruit) stick to the fur of animals. In the '60s Japanese researchers experimented with ways in which polymers can be infused with carbon fibre inventing strong and light composites, with never before seen strength-to-weight ratios. Everything from fishing rods to F1 cars and aerospace engineering benefitted from this. In 1965 DuPont created a high strength para-aramid synthetic fiber called Kevlar. (Counter Strike players are probably nodding their heads right now). Kevlar is literally bulletproof. Even the now ubiquitous "Fibre Optic" is a fibre. (Be sure to check out that entry)

Sound Recording

Thomas Edison invented his tin-foil phonograph which played recorded sounds from round cylinders. While working on improving the telegraph transmitter, he noted that weird sounds which sounded almost human were given off by the tape of the machine when played at a high speed. Edison, who was probably scared out of his senses before he realised that he was a scientist and then with a new-found bravado, reasoned that he could probably record a human voice. He experimented with the diaphragm of the telephone receiver by attaching a needle to it and came to the obvious deduction that the needle could prick paper tape to record a message. To everyone's surprise, this worked and was the first Phonograph or recording device. It was first marketed as a dictation device and was only later modified for recording music.